Revision Date:
July 17, 2020

Background:
This section defines terms commonly used in the Medi-Cal program. Definitions contained in this section are intended to serve as a resource for staff, not to provide regulations. Definitions identified below are in alphabetical order.

Purpose:
This section has been written in the current format; no rules or procedures were changed.

Policy:
Acronyms
The table below shows the common acronyms used in the Medi-Cal program and a definition of those terms.

Acronym	Definition
A&D FPL	Aged & Disabled Federal Poverty Level
AAP	Adoptions Assistance Program
ABD	Aged, Blind, or Disabled
ACA	Affordable Care Act
ACWDL	All County Welfare Directors Letter
ADS	Alcohol & Drug Services
AE	Accelerated Enrollment
AEVS	Automated Eligibility Verification System
AIS	Aging & Independence Services
AR	Authorized Representative
AVP	Asset Verification Program
BEER	Benefits Earnings and Exchange Report
BCCTP	Breast and Cervical Cancer Treatment Program
BIC	Benefits Identification Card
BPAI	Bureau of Public Assistance Investigations
CalHEERS	California Healthcare Eligibility, Enrollment, and Retention System
CalSAWS	California Statewide Automated Welfare System
CalWORKs	California Work Opportunity and Responsibility to Kids
CalWIN	CalWORKs Information Network
CCHEA	Consumer Center for Health Education & Advocacy
CDA	California Department of Aging
CDMHS	California Department of Mental Health Services
CDPH	California Department of Public Health
CDSS	California Department of Social Services
CE	Categorically Eligible
CEC	Continuous Eligibility for Children
CHDP	Child Health and Disability Prevention
CHEP	Cuban Haitian Entrant Program

Acronym	Definition
CHHS	California Health and Human Services
CHIP	Children's Health Insurance Program
CIN	Client Identification Number
CMRV	Current Market Rental Value
CMS	County Medical Services
CMV	Current Market Value
CSRA	Community Spouse Resource Allowance
CWD	County Welfare Department
CWDA	County Welfare Directors Association
DAC	Disabled Adult Children
DCSS	Department of Child Support Services
DDS	Department of Developmental Services
DDSD	Disability Determination Services Division
DHCS	Department of Health Care Services
DHS	Department of Homeland Security
DIB	Disability Insurance Benefits
DPM	Deceased Person Match
DRA	Deficit Reduction Act of 2005
DSH	Disproportionate Share Hospital
DSS	Department of Social Services
EAS	Eligibility and Assistance Standards
EBT	Electronic Benefit Transfer
EDC	Estimated Date of Confinement
EDD	Employment Development Department
EIC	Earned Income Credit
EITC	Earned Income Tax Credit
EMA	Entrant Medical Assistance
EPSDT	Early and Periodic Screening, Diagnosis, and Treatment
ETS	Employment Training Services
FFP	Federal Financial Participation
FFY	Former Foster Youth
FPL	Federal Poverty Level
FPLB	Federal Poverty Level for the Blind
FQHC	Federal Qualified Health Center
FRC	Family Resource Center
FTB	Franchise Tax Board
HHSA	Health and Human Services Agency
HCO	Health Care Options
HIC	Health Insurance Claim Number
HIPAA	Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act
HIPP	Health Insurance Premium Payment Program
HOS	Hospital Outstation
HPE	Hospital Presumptive Eligibility
ICE	Immigration and Customs Enforcement

Acronym	Definition
ICF	Intermediate Care Facility
ICT	Inter-County Transfer
IEVS	Income and Eligibility Verification System
IFD	Integrated Fraud Detection
IHO	In-Home Operations
IHSS	In-Home Supportive Services
IMD	Institution for Mental Diseases
IRCA	Immigration Reform and Control Act
IRWE	Impairment Related Work Expenses
IRS	Internal Revenue Service
ISM	In-Kind Support and Maintenance
ITIN	Individual Taxpayer Identification Number
Kin-GAP	Kinship Guardianship Assistance Payment
LAS	Legal Aid Society
LIS	Low Income Subsidy
LOA	Letter of Authorization
LPR	Legal Permanent Resident
LTC	Long-Term Care
MAGI	Modified Adjusted Gross Income
MBSAC	Minimum Basic Standard of Adequate Care
MCAP	Medi-Cal Access Program
MCCA	Medicare Catastrophic Coverage Act
MCHIP	Maternal and Child Health Integrated Program
MCIEP	Medi-Cal Inmate Eligibility Program
MEDIL	Medi-Cal Eligibility Division Information Letter
MEDS	Medi-Cal Eligibility Data System
MEPM	Medi-Cal Eligibility Procedures Manual
MFBU	Medi-Cal Family Budget Unit
MHS	Mental Health Services
MI	Medically Indigent
MMMNA	Minimum Monthly Maintenance Needs Allowance
MMNA	Monthly Maintenance Need Allowance
MN	Medically Needy
MPG	Medi-Cal Program Guide
MPP	Manual of Policies and Procedures
MSP	Medicare Savings Programs
MSSP	Multipurpose Senior Service Program
NANA	Newborn Automatic Number Assignment
NHR	New Hire Registry
NOA	Notice of Action
NPM	Nationwide Prisoner Match
NSLP	National School Lunch Program
OBRA	Omnibus Budget Reconciliation Act
OHC	Other Health Coverage

Acronym	Definition
ORR	Office of Refugee Resettlement
OTLICP	Optional Targeted Low-Income Children's Program
PA	Public Assistance
PACE	Program for All Inclusive Care for the Elderly
PCCM	Primary Care Case Management
PCN	Perinatal Care Network
PCSP	Personal Care Services Program
PD	Presumptive Disability
PE	Presumptive Eligibility
PHP	Prepaid Health Plan
PMV	Presumed Maximum Value
POE	Proof of Eligibility
POS	Point of Service
PRUCOL	Permanently Residing Under Color of Law
PVS	Payment Verification System
QDWI	Qualified Disabled Working Individual
QI	Qualified Individual
QMB	Qualified Medicare Beneficiary
RCA	Refugee Cash Assistance
RD	Renal Dialysis
RDP	Registered Domestic Partner
ROP	Reasonable Opportunity Period
RMA	Refugee Medical Assistance
RRB	Railroad Retirement Board
RSDI	Retirement, Survivor's, and Disability Insurance
SAVE	Systematic Alien Verification for Entitlements
SAW	Special Agricultural Worker
SDI	State Disability Insurance
SDX	State Data Exchange
SGA	Substantial Gainful Activity
SIS	Satisfactory Immigration Status
SLMB	Specified Low-Income Medicare Beneficiary
SNF	Skilled Nursing Facility
SOC	Share of Cost
SOF	Statement of Facts
SPE	Single Point of Entry
SSA	Social Security Administration
SSI/SSP	Supplemental Security Income/State Supplemental Program
SSN	Social Security Number
SW	Social Worker
TB	Tuberculosis
TMC	Transitional Medi-Cal
TPL	Third Party Liability
TPN	Total Parenteral Nutrition

Acronym	Definition
UIB	Unemployment Insurance Benefit
USCIS	United States Citizenship and Immigration Services
VTR	Value of the One-Third Reduction
WD	Working Disabled
WIC	Women, Infants, and Children
WRE	Work Related Expense

Definitions

The table below shows the common terms used in the Medi-Cal program along with a definition.

<table>
<tr><th>Term</th><th>Definition</th></tr>
<tr><td>Accelerated Enrollment</td><td>The AE program provides immediate, temporary, full-scope, zero SOC Medi-Cal coverage to children under 19 who are new to Medi-Cal and applied for Medi-Cal through California Health Eligibility, Enrollment, and Retention System (CalHEERS).</td></tr>
<tr><td>Accurately Reflect</td><td>A reasonable determination of current income based on what the customer reported on the Statement of Facts when compared to provided verifications.
<table>
<tr><th>If …</th><th>Then …</th></tr>
<tr><td>There is a discrepancy between the amounts of income declared and the amounts reflected on the verification,</td><td>Use the best judgment as to the correct amount of current income.</td></tr>
<tr><td>Not able to determine the correct income,</td><td>Consult the supervisor.</td></tr>
<tr><td>Still not able to make a reasonable determination of income, or the discrepancy would result in ineligibility to a Medi-Cal program,</td><td>Contact the customer to clarify. Document the determination in Case Comments.</td></tr>
</table></td></tr>
<tr><td>Adequate Consideration</td><td>The receipt of cash or property, which is fair and reasonable under the circumstances considering the net market value of property that is sold, converted, or transferred.</td></tr>
<tr><td>Adoptions Assistance Program</td><td>Removes or reduces barriers to the adoption of children who otherwise would remain in long-term foster care.</td></tr>
<tr><td>Adult</td><td>A person meeting any of the criteria below:
21 years of age or older
Blind or disabled MN 18 to 21 years of age, living in the home of a parent, and not currently enrolled in school
MN or MI 18 to 21 years of age, not living in the home of a parent or caretaker relative, not claimed as a tax dependent of his/her parent(s), and not receiving out-of-home care from a public agency
14 to 18 years of age not living in the home of a parent or caretaker relative and does not have a parent, caretaker relative, or legal guardian handling any of his/her financial affairs.</td></tr>
</table>

Term	Definition
Adverse Action	An action taken which discontinues Medi-Cal eligibility or increases an MFBU's SOC, or reduces the scope of benefits (for example, zero SOC to premium OTLICP and full-scope to restricted). The following are not considered to be an adverse action: • Discontinuance due to any of the following reasons: o Death, for a one-person MFBU o The whereabouts of the beneficiary is unknown, and the post office has returned HHSA mail sent to the beneficiary indicating no forwarding address o Admission to an institution, which renders the beneficiary ineligible. o The beneficiary also has Medi-Cal eligibility under another identity or category, or in another county or state, or will have such dual eligibility as of the first of the coming month if discontinuance action is not taken o Receipt of the beneficiary's clear and signed written statement that does either of the following: ▪ States that the beneficiary no longer wants Medi-Cal benefits ▪ Gives information that requires discontinuance and includes the beneficiary's acknowledgement that he/she knows Medi-Cal will stop due to this information • Increase in an MFBU's SOC due to either of the following: o The voluntary inclusion of eligible family members who currently are not receiving benefits under any Medi-Cal program. o Receipt of the beneficiary's clear and signed written statement which gives information which requires an increase in SOC and includes the beneficiary's acknowledgement that the increase must be the consequence of supplying such information.
Aged & Disabled Federal Poverty Level Program	Provides zero SOC Medi-Cal to qualified aged or disabled individuals throughout the State of California.
Aged, Blind, or Disabled	People age 65 or older, or considered legally blind, or with a disability (as classified by SSA or DDSD). People in the Aged, Blind, or Disabled category receive greater income deductions which may mean a lower SOC.
Aging and Independence Services	Serves older adults, disabled persons, those at risk of abuse, people with HIV or AIDS, and others who would be at risk of institutionalization.
Aid Category	People who apply for Medi-Cal must have their eligibility evaluated according to the regulations governing the category to which the person or family is linked.
Aid Code	Used to determine the types of services for which Medi-Cal beneficiaries are eligible and the funding source: state, federal, or a combination of both.
All County Welfare Directors Letter	DHCS provides county public social services agencies with ACWDLs regarding new or changed policies and/or procedures used in determining eligibility for Medi-Cal benefits.

Term	Definition
Applicant	The individual or family either: • Making an application for aid • On whose behalf an application is made • Requesting a restoration or reapplication
Approval of Eligibility	Applicants who meet conditions of eligibility and their applications are approved for Medi-Cal based on an eligibility determination.
Authorized Representative	Person or organization authorized by a customer to apply for any of the health care programs and to perform the duties required to establish and maintain eligibility.
Automated Eligibility Verification System	Enables providers to verify eligibility via the telephone.
Beneficiary	An individual who becomes eligible for Medi-Cal under a specific category.
Benefits Identification Card	Card used to access the California Eligibility and Claims Management System to verify eligibility and SOC payment or obligation.
Board and Care	Nonmedical, community-based residential care for individuals who can care for themselves; meals and supervision are provided.
Breast and Cervical Cancer Treatment Program	Provides cancer treatment for eligible low-income California residents who are screened by the cancer detection program and found to need treatment for breast and/or cervical cancer.
Bureau of Public Assistance Investigations	Preventing, detecting, deterring, and prosecuting fraud or for those who obtain public aid they are not eligible to protects the interests of those in genuine need and conserves taxpayer resources.
Burial Insurance	Insurance, which by its terms can only be used to pay the burial expenses of the insured.
California Department of Aging	Administers programs that serve older adults, adults with disabilities, family caregivers, and residents in long-term care facilities throughout the State.
California Department of Social Services	Responsible for the oversight and administration of programs serving California's most vulnerable residents.
CalWIN	Online, real-time computer program that supports the administration of public assistance programs.
CalWORKs	Program that provides temporary assistance in the form of cash aid and services to needy families with minor children.
Caretaker Relative	A relative who provides care and supervision to a child. The caretaker relative may be any relation by blood, marriage, or adoption who is within the fifth degree of relationship to the dependent child.
Cash-Based Medi-Cal	Medi-Cal benefits which are based upon a determination of eligibility for a cash grant.
Cash Grant	The money payment made to a person eligible for CalWORKs or SSI/SSP.

Term	Definition
Categorically Eligible	The person has met the requirements for the program, without requiring a separate determination.
Certification Date for Claims Clearance	The date in which the beneficiary met his/her SOC.
Certification Effective Date	The date the person is certified to receive Medi-Cal benefits.
Certification for Medi-Cal	The determination that a person is eligible for Medi-Cal and has no SOC, has met the SOC, or is in LTC and has a SOC that is less than the cost of LTC at the Medi-Cal rate.
Child	A person under the age of 21 except that the following people are considered adults: • Blind or disabled MN 18 to 21 years of age, living in the home of a parent, and not currently enrolled in school • MN or MI 18 to 21 years of age, not living in the home of a parent or caretaker relative, not claimed as a tax dependent of his/her parent(s), and not receiving out-of-home care from a public agency • 14 to 18 years of age not living in the home of a parent or caretaker relative and does not have a parent, caretaker relative, or legal guardian handling any of his/her financial affairs. An unborn is considered a child for Medi-Cal purposes.
Child Health and Disability Prevention Program	The community-based program for early identification and referral for treatment of people under 21 years of age with potentially handicapping conditions.
Children's Health Insurance Program (CHIP)	CHIP provides health coverage to eligible children. CHIP provides federal funding to states to initiate and expand health assistance to uninsured low-income children with income too high to qualify for Medi-Cal, but too low to purchase private insurance.is administered by states, following federal requirements. Medicaid law under Title XIX was amended to allow state the option to expand coverage to uninsured children through Medi-Cal which is now a coverage group in OTLICP and was previously known as Healthy Families, AIM, and Medi-Cal's FPL programs for children. The aid code would determine the funding source depending on the title that the aid is provided: Title XIX: Medi-Cal OTLICP Title XXI: CHIP
Client Identification Number	Unique identifier assigned to beneficiaries by MEDS.
Combination Cases	An MFBU, which contains more than one assistance program for eligible people.

Term	Definition
Common-Law Marriage	A common-law marriage is established when: • A man and a woman both agree by written and verbal statement that they are husband and wife. The words must be in the present tense and must express intent to assume the relationship of husband and wife at the time involved and not at some future time. • The parties must have the capacity to enter the agreement. This means that they must be of sound mind and of the minimum age. • There must be cohabitation (living together as husband and wife and hold themselves out to the public as husband and wife) following the verbal or written statement. If these facts are established and the state where it occurred recognizes common-law marriages, a marriage is in existence which is valid for all purposes in California and which can only be dissolved by formal divorce even in the state in which it was created. See Desk Aid 112 to validate which states recognize common-law marriages.
Community Property	Property acquired by either spouse during marriage unless the property was acquired as separate property or with funds that can be identified as separate property.
Community Spouse	The spouse of an institutionalized individual who is not in LTC.
Community Spouse Resource Allowance	A spouse who continues to reside in the community after the other spouse has entered a long-term care facility is entitled to retain a portion of the couple's resources.
Competent	A person able to act on one's own behalf in business and personal matters.
Comprehensive Prepaid Health Plan	A PHP that is required by contract with the State to provide full scope benefits available under the Medi-Cal program.
Contiguous Property	Adjacent or adjoining property that is not separated by a road, street, right of way, or in any other manner from property being considered.
Continuous Eligibility for Children	Provides no SOC Medi-Cal benefits to certain children up to the age of 19.
Conversion of Property	Changing the property from one form to another without changing ownership.
County Agency	Either an administrative division of a county government or a non-county organization that has a contract with the county to act on the county's behalf.
County Dollar Error Rate	Medi-Cal dollars paid in error in the eligibility quality control sample divided by the Medi-Cal dollars paid in the sample.
County Medical Services	A county-funded program for adults 21 through 64 years of age who are ineligible for Medi-Cal.
County Welfare Department	Agency that provides social welfare services to citizens in need to include, but are not limited to, cash, food assistance, employment services, and medical needs.

Term	Definition
Covered California	Service that connects Californians with health insurance under the Affordable Care Act.
Cuban-Haitian Entrant Program	Provide asylum and humanitarian assistance to people subject to persecution in their homelands. Assistance which helps refugees adapt to their new country, become economically self-sufficient, and ultimately participate in and contribute to their new communities.
Current Market Rental Value	Income from rental property minus allowable expenses.
Current Market Value	Real property determined by the assessed value of the most recent property tax assessment or value established through an appraisal by a qualified real estate appraiser.
Deficit Reduction Act of 2005	Act made changes in mandatory spending under legal entitlements and tax laws to achieve savings in the federal budget and outlay.
Department of Child Support Services	Establishes child and medical support orders, enforces/modifies child and medical support orders, and collects and distributes child and spousal support payments.
Department of Developmental Services	Provides services and support to individuals with developmental disabilities.
Department of Health Care Services	The state agency charged with administering the Medicaid program for the Federal government.
Disabled Adult Children	Person who became permanently disabled before the age of 22 and is now over the age of 22.
Disability Determination Services Division	DDSD is responsible for evaluating medical and employment data to determine if a customer meets the federal definition of disability. “Inability to engage in any substantial gainful activity by reason of a medically determinable physical or mental impairment which can be expected to result in death or has lasted or can be expected to last for a continuous period of not less than twelve months.”
Disability Insurance Benefits	Provides support when a person is unable to work.
Disproportionate Share Hospital	System of payment for the operating costs of acute care hospital inpatient stays.
Early and Periodic Screening, Diagnosis, and Treatment	Comprehensive and preventive child health program for individuals under the age of 21.
Eligibility and Assistance Standards	The portion of the MPP published by the CDSS which includes regulations pertaining to the CalWORKs and SSP programs.

Term	Definition
Eligibility Services	A service provided by HHSA relating to the initial and continuing determination of a person's or family's Medi-Cal eligibility.
Employment Development Department	Administers the Job Service, Unemployment Insurance, Disability Insurance, and Workforce Investment Act.
Employment Training Services	Provides a comprehensive range of employment and training services in partnership with local agencies.
Encumbrances of Record	Obligations for which property is security as evidenced by a written document.
Entrant Medical Assistance	Certain refugees for whom assistance is authorized with documentation for USCIS.
Estimated Date of Confinement	The due date or estimated calendar date when a baby will be born.
Family Member	The following people living in the home: • A child or sibling children • The parents (married or unmarried) of the sibling children • The stepparents of the sibling children • The separate children of either unmarried parent or the parent or stepparent. If there are no children, family member means a single person or a married couple.
Family Resource Center	Facility offering self-sufficiency services.
Federal Financial Participation	Federal Medicaid matching funds paid to the State for allowable expenditures for Medicaid services or administrative costs.
Federal Poverty Level	An income limit based on the official poverty level as defined by the Federal Office of Management and Budget and revised annually.
Federal Poverty Level for the Blind	Program covers blind individuals pursuant to Title XVI who have not yet or cannot meet the Title II criteria for disability based upon blindness.
Federal Qualified Health Center	All organizations receiving grants under Section 330 of the Public Health Service Act.
Former Foster Youth	Provides full, no cost Medi-Cal for people who were in foster care on their 18th birthday and who were released from foster care due to age.
Franchise Tax Board	The department that collects state personal income taxes and bank and corporation taxes for the State of California.
Health and Human Services Agency	Principal agency for protecting the health of all Americans and providing essential human services, especially for those who are least able to help themselves.

Term	Definition
Health Care Options	Gives health care services through networks of organized systems of care.
Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act	Federal law that mandates that each state has the capacity to exchange data with the Medicare program and which contains provisions that require state Medicaid programs to use standard, national codes for electronic transactions related to the processing of health claims. Mandates certain standards and practices about privacy of consumer health information.
Health Insurance Premium Payment Program	Enrollment of a beneficiary in a group health plan which is cost effective.
Heirloom	Any item of personal property, other than cash or securities, which has substantial sentimental value, has been owned by a family for at least two generations, and has the intention to be retained by the family in succeeding generations.
Home	Real or personal property, fixed or mobile, located on land or water, in which a person or family lives.
Hospital Outstation	Hospitals contracting with the Hospital Council to have workers stationed in their facilities to process Medi-Cal and CMS applications for inpatients and patients scheduled for admittance.
Immigration Reform and Control Act	Granted amnesty to certain undocumented immigrants who entered the United States before January 1, 1982 and have resided there continuously.
Impairment Related Work Expenses	Deduction for out-of-pocket expenses for items such as medicine, medical supplies, medical devices, service animals, and disposable items such as bandages and syringes when figuring the amount of earned income.
Income and Eligibility Verification System	The federally mandated system established to obtain, use, and verify information relevant to determination of eligibility and SOC.
In-Home Supportive Services	The social services program, which provides necessary personal and domestic care so that an aged, blind, or disabled person may remain in their own home.
In-Kind Support and Maintenance	Unearned income that is not cash or a check when someone else pays for or provides food and/or shelter.
Inmate	A person living or confined in an institution. Excluded from this definition are people residing at a facility for vocational training or educational purposes, and people temporarily in an institution pending more suitable arrangements, such as children in a local agency facility pending foster care placement.

<table>
<tr><th>Term</th><th>Definition</th></tr>
<tr><td>Institution</td><td>An establishment which provides food and shelter to four or more people unrelated to the proprietor and in addition provides some treatment or services which meet needs beyond the basic provision of food and shelter.
<table>
<tr><th>Institution</th><th>Definition</th></tr>
<tr><td>Medical</td><td>Any public or private acute care hospital, acute psychiatric hospital, intermediate care facility, skilled nursing facility, or other medical facility licensed by an officially designated state standard setting authority.</td></tr>
<tr><td>Mental Diseases</td><td>An institution primarily engaged in providing diagnosis, treatment, or care for people with mental illness.</td></tr>
<tr><td>Non-medical</td><td>Any institution providing non-medical residential care, custodial care, custody, or restraint. This includes penal institutions.</td></tr>
<tr><td>Private</td><td>A proprietary or nonprofit facility managed and controlled by an individual, private association, or cooperation.</td></tr>
<tr><td>Public</td><td>An institution that is the responsibility of a government unit or over which a governmental unit exercises administrative control. Excluded from this definition are medical facilities and publicly operated community residences.</td></tr>
<tr><td>Tuberculosis</td><td>An institution which is primarily engaged in providing diagnosis, treatment, or care of people with tuberculosis, including medical attention, nursing care, and related services.</td></tr>
</table></td></tr>
<tr><td>Institutionalized Spouse</td><td>Beginning on the date of application an institutionalized spouse is one who is all the following:
Applying for Medi-Cal after January 1, 1990
Beginning a continuous period of institutionalization after September 20, 1989, as an inpatient in a medical institution, nursing facility, or applying for or receiving Home and Community-Based Services (HCBS)
Is expected to remain in the medical institution, nursing facility, or receive HCBS for a continuous period of at least 30 consecutive days as evidenced by a statement signed and dated by the physician of the institutionalized spouse. Non-receipt of nursing facility level of care for a full calendar month is considered a termination of a continuous period of institutionalization
Has a community spouse
Is not AFDC-MN</td></tr>
<tr><td>Intermediate Care Facility</td><td>A facility which provides services to patients who:
Require protection and supportive care above board and care level
Do not require continuous supervision by a licensed registered or vocational nurse
Do not have an illness, injury, or disability for which hospital or skilled nursing facilities are required</td></tr>
</table>

Term	Definition
Interprogram Transfer	A transfer of eligibility from one aid category to another aid category, in which the first digit of the aid code changes.
Intraprogram Status Change	A change in a person's or family's eligibility from one aid category to another aid category, in which the first digit of the aid code remains the same.
Kinship Guardian Assistance Program	Support payments for foster children who have been placed in long-term foster care with a relative caregiver.
Letter of Authorization	Proof of eligibility that occurred at least 12 months prior to the current month.
Life Insurance	A contract for which premiums are paid during the lifetime of the insured and on which the insuring company pays the face amount of the policy to the beneficiary upon the death of the insured. Life insurance may also be purchased by a single premium or by letting dividends accumulate.
Limited Service Status	The beneficiary's use of Medi-Cal is limited because of enrollment in a comprehensive PHO, improper usage of service, application as a child under Minor Consent services, or participation in a pilot project conducted by the State.
Linked	Meeting the SSI/SSP requirements of age, blindness, or disability.
Long-Term Care Spouse	An institutionalized spouse regardless of the date of admission to the LTC facility.
Long-Term Care Status	Inpatient medical care, which lasts for more than the month of admission and is expected to last for at least one full calendar month after the month of admission.
Manual of Policies and Procedures	Provides clarification to county social services staff on policies and procedures for making eligibility determinations for the Medi-Cal program. Issued by CDSS.
Marriage	The state of being married, including a common-law marriage (for further details on legal common-law marriage, see common-law marriage).
Medi-Cal	California's medical assistance program and the benefits available under that program. Medi-Cal is the California state plan version of the federal Medicaid program.
Medi-Cal Dollar Error Rate Standard	The statewide dollar error rate tolerance level established by the State to measure county performance in the accurate determination of Medi-Cal eligibility and SOC for MN and MI beneficiaries.
Medi-Cal Eligibility Quality Control	• Federally mandated review of Medi-Cal cases to ensure proper determination of eligibility. • State mandated review of Medi-Cal cases within individual counties to ensure proper determination of eligibility.
Medi-Cal Eligibility Data System	State information system that supports the operations of the Medi-Cal program that contains sub-systems and files for beneficiary eligibility.

Term	Definition
Medi-Cal Eligibility Division Information Letter	Information letter used to provide clarification and implementation of Medi-Cal regulations, policy, and procedures to assure that Medi-Cal eligibility is determined accurately and timely.
Medi-Cal Eligibility Procedures Manual	State manual that provides clarification to county social services staff on procedures for making eligibility determinations for the Medi-Cal program. Issued by DHCS.
Medi-Cal Family Budget Unit	The people who will be included in the Medi-Cal eligibility and SOC determination.
Medi-Cal Only Eligibility	A person's or family's eligibility for Medi-Cal benefits that has been determined independently of an eligibility determination for any other aid or benefit program.
Medically Needy Person or Family	A person or family eligible under the MN program. These people are linked to a federal program.
Medi-Cal Program Guide	County manual that provides instruction to County eligibility staff on regulations, policies, and procedures for making eligibility determinations for the Medi-Cal program.
Medicare Catastrophic Coverage Act	Created to preserve the assets of the aged due to catastrophic illness.
Minimum Basic Standard of Adequate Care	The amount necessary to provide a CalWORKs family with basic needs as specified in the EAS manual.
Minor Consent Services	Services related to: • Sexual assault • Drug or alcohol abuse for children 12 years of age or older • Pregnancy • Family planning • Venereal disease (sexually transmitted diseases designated by the State) for children 12 years of age or older • Mental health care for children 12 years of age or older who are mature enough to participate intelligently and which is needed to prevent the children from seriously harming themselves or others or because the children are the alleged victims of incest or child abuse.
Minor Parent	A parent who meets the definition of a child and has his/her children living in the home.
Modified Adjusted Gross Income	MAGI is the term for Medi-Cal that uses tax rules to determine eligibility.
Multiple Dwelling Unit	Any dwelling with more than one separate living unit, which normally would include, as a minimum, a bathroom and a kitchen.

Term	Definition
Multipurpose Senior Service Program	Provides social and health care management for frail elderly customers who are certifiable for placement in a nursing facility but who wish to remain in the community.
National School Lunch Program	Federally assisted meal program operating in public and nonprofit private schools and residential childcare institutions that provides nutritionally balanced, low-cost, or free lunches to children each school day.
Newborn Automatic Number Assignment	If parents choose to have a SSN automatically assigned to their newborn child, federal law requires the inclusion of at least one parent's SSN on the birth record.
Nonrecurring Lump Sum Payment	A payment accrued over more than one calendar month and not expected to be received again in the future. It does not include the amount of the monthly benefit for the month the lump sum is received. For instance, a Social Security lump sum payment would have the current month payment subtracted from the lump sum payment to determine the amount of the lump sum. See Desk Aid 56 for treatment in MAGI determinations.
Notice of Action	Notification that provides customers with clear communication for accurate eligibility status, the reasons why actions are taken, and appeal rights.
Nursing Facility	An intermediate care facility or a skilled nursing facility.
Obligate	To incur a cost for health care services.
Office of Refugee Resettlement	Provides people in need with critical resources to assist them in becoming integrated members of American society.
Optional Targeted Low-Income Children's Program	Provides medical coverage for children through 19 years of age with family income below 266% FPL. This program also includes California's CHIP expansion.
Other Health Coverage	Any benefit for health-related services or entitlements for which a Medi-Cal beneficiary is eligible under any private, group, or government insurance program.
Other PA Recipient	A person eligible for Medi-Cal under one of the categories in the Other PA program.
Overpayment	The receipt of Medi-Cal benefits or a portion of benefits when there is no eligibility.
Parent	The natural or adoptive parent of a child.
Patient	A person receiving individual professional services directed by a licensed practitioner of the healing arts towards maintenance, improvement, or protection of health, or the alleviation of disability or pain.
Payment Verification System	A monthly match that provides information on RSDI benefits, UIB, and SDI.

Term	Definition
People Living in the Home	• Includes all the following: ○ People physically present in the home ○ People temporarily absent from the home because of hospitalization, visiting, vacation, trips in connection with work, or because of similar reasons to an 18 to 21-year-old as shown below ○ People away at school or vocational training who will resume living in the home as evidenced by the person returning home for vacations, weekends, and at other times. • A temporary absence is normally one in which the person leaves and returns to the home in the same month or the following month. • A child temporarily absent from the home is living in the home if the parent continues to have responsibility for the care and control of a child until the court removes this responsibility or the parent voluntarily relinquishes it. • An 18 to 21-year-old or unmarried minor parent living on the parent's property is not living in the parent's home if both following conditions exist: ○ The 18 to 21-year-old or unmarried minor parent does not receive any support from the parents ○ The building the 18 to 21-year-old or unmarried minor parent lives in would be considered other real property of the parents. • A person whose institutional status results in ineligibility
Perinatal Care Network	Works with families eligible for pregnancy related Medi-Cal to make sure that women get prenatal care and other services they need.
Permanently Residing Under Color of Law	Noncitizen permanently residing in the United States who is not under a direct, final order of deportation.
Personal Care Services Program	Provides services such as housekeeping, meal preparation, bathing, toileting, and grooming.
Personal Property	Possession or interests, exclusive of real property, that may be easily transported or stored; including but not limited to cash on hand, bank accounts, notes, mortgages, deeds of trust, cash surrender value of life insurance, motor vehicles, uncollected judgements, an interest in a firm in receivership, a lawsuit, patents, and copyrights.
Point of Services	Device used to verify recipient eligibility, clear SOC liability, reserve Medi-Cal services, and submit and adjudicate pharmacy claims online.
Prepaid Health Plan	Contracts between an insurer and subscriber or a group of subscribers whereby a specified set of health benefits is provided in return for a periodic premium.
Presumed Maximum Value	Presume that the value of support and maintenance does not exceed a certain maximum amount.
Presumptive Disability	Presumes that a person is disabled while a more formal determination of their disability is under consideration.
Presumptive Eligibility	Program allows qualified Medi-Cal providers throughout the state to provide their low-income patients immediate, temporary Medi-Cal coverage for prenatal care.

Term	Definition
Primary Care Case Management Plan	Any person or organization who: • Has entered into a contract with DHCS on a capitalized or risk sharing basis, or both, to provide or arrange for the provision of health care services • Meets the requirements for participation in the Medicaid program on an at-risk basis.
Program for All Inclusive Care for the Elderly	A comprehensive service package that permits the elderly to continue living at home while receiving services rather than be institutionalized.
Proof of Eligibility	Verification on the period to which a person is eligible for Medi-Cal, including retroactive eligibility.
Public Agency	An administrative division of local, state, or federal government, or an organization that has a contract to act in behalf of the local, state, or federal government.
Public Assistance Recipient	A person or family receiving assistance under the CalWORKs, SSI/SSP, or Refugee Assistance programs.
Public Funds	Money provided by a local, state, or federal government.
Publicly Operated Community Residence	A facility designed and planned to serve no more than 16 residents, which is serving 16 or fewer residents. The facility provides food and shelter and must provide some additional services such as: • Social services • Help with personal activities • Training in socialization and life skills. Excluded from this definition are: • Residential facilities located on the grounds or immediately adjacent to any large institution or multi-purpose complex • Educational or vocational training facilities • Correctional or holding facilities for people detained under the penal system • Medical treatment facilities.
Qualified Disabled Working Individual	An individual who meets the eligibility criteria for the QDWI program specified in MPG 5.13.6.
Qualified Disaster	A natural disaster is designated as qualifying disaster by federal, state, or local agencies or certain other personal hardship.
Qualified Individual	An individual who meets the eligibility criteria for the QI program specified in MPG 5.13.5.
Qualified Medicare Beneficiary	An individual who meets the eligibility criteria for the QI program specified in MPG 5.13.3.

Term	Definition
Railroad Retirement Board	Administers a federal retirement benefit program covering the nation's railroad workers.
Real Property	Land and improvements, which generally include any immovable property attached to the land and any oil, mineral, timber, or other rights related to the land.
Reapplication	An application for Medi-Cal only eligibility made in the same county as a previous application, if the previous application was denied or withdrawn or Medi-Cal only eligibility based on the previous application has been discontinued for more than 12 months.
Reasonable Opportunity Period	Defined as the time needed for the customer to obtain valid documentation.
Recipient	A person or family receiving aid under a PA program or the Other PA program.
Redetermination	The review of a person's or family's Medi-Cal eligibility.
Refugee Cash Assistance	A 100% federally funded program that provides social services and cash assistance for a limited time.
Refugee Medical Assistance	A 100% federally funded program that provides up to eight months of health care coverage to certain noncitizens who are considered refugees under the Immigration and Naturalization Act.
Registered Domestic Partner	Registered legal relationship available to same-sex couples, and to certain opposite-sex couples in which at least one party is at least 62 years of age. It affords the couple the same rights, protections, and benefits, and is subject to the same responsibilities, obligations, and duties under law as married spouses.
Relative	• A parent (1st degree), grandparent (2nd degree), sibling (3rd degree), a great-grandparent (3rd degree), uncle or aunt (3rd degree), nephew or niece (3rd degree), great-great-grandparent (4th degree), great-uncle or aunt (4th degree), great-great-great-grandparent (5th degree), great-great uncle or aunt (5th degree), or a first cousin once removed (5th degree) • A stepfather, stepmother, stepbrother, or stepsister • A spouse even after the marriage has been terminated by death or dissolution but not by annulment • A person (or his/her relatives) who legally adopts the child Example: If Anne and Betty are cousins, Betty's children are first cousins once removed to Anne and Anne's children are first cousins once removed to Betty. Anne's children and Betty's children are second cousins.
Renal Dialysis	The process of filtering the blood, the way kidneys normally do, using a machine.
Repayment	The recovery of an overpayment in response to a demand by DHCS.
Residence	The place in which a person or family lives or is physically present if the person or family has no present intention of leaving.

Term	Definition
Responsible Relative	A relative who is responsible to contribute to the cost of health care services received by a Medi-Cal beneficiary.
Restoration	The approval of Medi-Cal only eligibility for a person or family in the same county as that in which they were previously eligible for Medi-Cal only, if the effective date of the approval occurs within 12 months of the end of the previous period of eligibility.
Retirement, Survivor's, and Disability Insurance	Program operated by SSA that provides a monthly income to certain people based on payroll contributions made via Social Security taxes.
Satisfactory Immigration Status	An immigration status that makes the individual eligible for full-scope benefits under the applicable program.
Separate Property	Any item that is to be considered separate property under California Property Law. Generally, separate property is acquired by an individual by any method prior to marriage, after obtaining an interlocutory, or final judgment of dissolution, or while voluntarily separated, or at any time by gift or inheritance, or purchases made with funds that are separate property or with funds from the sale of separate property.
Share of Community Property	To determine Medi-Cal eligibility, share of community property is to be treated as if each spouse owns one-half of the community property.
Share of Cost	A person's or family's net income more than their maintenance need that must be paid or obligated toward the cost of health care services monthly before the person or family may be certified.
Share of Encumbrance	That portion of any encumbrances attributed to each portion of jointly owned property.
Single Point of Entry	Provides a uniform, centralized process for the receipt, processing, and tracking of applications.
Skilled Nursing Facility	A health facility or a distinct part of a hospital, which provides skilled nursing care and supportive care to patients whose primary need, is for skilled nursing care on an extended basis. It provides 24-hour care and, as a minimum, includes nursing, dietary, pharmaceutical services, and an activity program.
Social Security Administration	Independent agency of the United States federal government that administers Social Security, a social insurance program consisting of retirement, disability, and survivor's benefits and Medicare.
Social Security Health Insurance Claim Number	Number assigned by the SSA to an individual identifying them as a Medicare beneficiary.
Social Security Number	A nine-digit number issued to U.S. citizens, permanent residents, and temporary (working) residents which primary purpose is to track individuals for taxation purposes.
Social Worker	Helping people overcome problems to make their lives better.

Term	Definition
Special Agricultural Workers	Immigrants who performed labor in perishable agricultural commodities for a specified period and were admitted for temporary and then permanent residence under a provision of the Immigration Reform and Control Act of 1986.
Specified Low-Income Medicare Beneficiary	An individual who meets the eligibility criteria for the QI program specified in MPG 5.13.4.
State Data Exchange	The data system by which the federal government provides information to the State regarding the eligibility of SSI/SSP applicants and recipients.
State Disability Insurance	Provides partial wage replacement to eligible workers who are unable to work because of a disability.
Stepparent	A person who is married to the parent of a child and who is not the natural or adoptive parent of the child.
Substantial Gainful Activity Disabled	People who were once determined disabled by SSI/SSP, became ineligible for SSI/SSP because of SGA, and still have the medical impairment which was the basis of the SSI/SSP disability determination.
Supplemental Security Income/State Supplemental Program	The federal and state payments, respectively, which are based on need, and are paid to aged, blind, or disabled people.
Systematic Alien Verification for Entitlements	Automated verification process to provide federal, state, and local benefit issuing agencies and institutions with immigration status information which will assist them in determining an individual's eligibility.
Therapeutic Wages	Wages earned by an individual when all the following conditions are met: • A physician who does not have a financial interest in the LTC facility in which the individual resides, and who oversees the individual's case, prescribes his work as therapy for the individual. • The individual must be employed by the same LTC facility in which he/she resides. • The individual's employment does not displace any existing employees. • The individual has resided in a LTC facility continuously since September 1979.
Third Party Liability	The responsibility of insurers for payment of claims which relate to injuries or trauma sustained by recipients becaise of fault or negligence of third parties (for example, auto accident claims). The State is responsible for assuring the use of third-party assets or for detection and collection of third-party liability payments.
Title II	Social Security benefits that provide monthly payments to aged, blind, or disabled people who have a previous earnings history. Payments are also paid to certain dependents and survivors. Recipients are not automatically eligible to receive Medi-Cal.

Term	Definition
Title IVA	CalWORKs. This program is administered by State agencies. Families receiving assistance through this program are automatically eligible to Medi-Cal.
Title XVI	SSI cash grant program. SSA administers the program that provides cash assistance to aged, blind, and disabled people whose income and resources are below certain levels. California has a SSP. People receiving SSI/SSP assistance are automatically eligible to Medi-Cal.
Title XVII	Medicare. This program is administered by SSA and provides health insurance to almost all aged individuals and certain disabled individuals. Medicare recipients are not automatically eligible to receive Medi-Cal.
Title XIX	Medicaid program. This program is administered by the state and federal agencies. The single agency in California is DHCS. In California, the program is called Medi-Cal.
Title XXI	Children's Health Insurance Program (see above), which is a coverage group under OTLICP.
Total Parenteral Nutrition	Feeding a person intravenously, bypassing the usual process of eating and digestion.
Transfer of Property	A change of ownership whereby a person no longer holds the title to, or beneficial interest in, property.
Transitional Medi-Cal	Comprehensive preventive care services for families who lost their cash based Medi-Cal due to earnings.
Tuberculosis	Contagious bacterial infection that mainly involves the lungs but may spread to other organs.
Unemployment Insurance Benefits	Provides temporary financial assistance to eligible workers who are unemployed through no fault of their own.
United States Citizenship and Immigration Services	Federal government agency that oversees lawful immigration to the United States, and citizenship services.
Unmarried Parents	Parents who are living together with their common child and the parents are not married to each other.
Value of the One-Third Reduction	An amount equal to one-third of the applicable Federal Benefit Rate is considered the value of the in-kind support and maintenance.
Verification	The process of obtaining acceptable evidence, which substantiates statements made by the customer.
Women, Infants, and Children	WIC provides Federal grants to States for supplemental food, health care referrals, and nutrition education for low-income pregnant, and postpartum women, and to infants and children up to age five who are found to be at nutritional risk.
Working Disabled Program	Disabled individuals who work and have income that is too high to qualify for other Medi-Cal categories can have up to 250% of the federal poverty level in countable income and still receive Medi-Cal benefits. Enrollees pay a monthly, sliding-scale premium for this coverage.

Term	Definition
Work Related Expenses	A standard deduction or an itemized deduction for ordinary and necessary expenses attributable to a customer's job.

Procedure:
See above.

Program Impacts:
None.

References:
None.

Sunset Date:
This policy will be reviewed for continuance by June 30, 2023

Approval for Release:

7-17-20

Rick Wanne, Director
Eligibility Operations